

Evan Jones

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Experience

Lead Data Scientist, FanDuel – Atlanta, GA

August 2025 – Present

- **Driving Innovation:** Architect and developer of a foundational personalization model set to power all personalization of Fanduel Sportsbook application. MVP for MLB player props increased conversion rate and stake by 8.2% & 8.5% respectively with 2.2x increase in median engagement time. Full rollout in progress.
- **Real-time Personalization:** Developed a bespoke two-tower retrieval model with hierarchal ranking layer to support full real-time user personalization on all FanDuel Picks application pages. Increased first time lobby conversion by 8% while improving existing user conversion and handle by 5% & 7% respectively
- **Optimizing Incentives:** Identified key customer segments of ineffective incentive spending. Developed several models and mechanisms to identify and withhold promotion offers high propensity and low ltv customers
- **Improving Search:** Improved trending search, auto-complete, and direct search results on Fanduel Sportsbook, Predicts, & Picks applications fully personalizing real-time search with foundational embedding models.

Senior Machine Learning Engineer, Mercedes-Benz – Atlanta, GA

February 2023 – August 2025

- **Driving Sales Growth:** Architect of "Hyperlocal," an ML system predicting sales opportunities and optimal production allocation by zip code. Piloted across Phoenix market achieving a 17% Y/Y GLE sales increase and 8% regional market share growth. System scaled nationally publicly known as the *road to 400k* initiative.
- **Reducing Costs:** Developer of "ECE," an ML system preventing lemon law buybacks and future critical repairs through telematics data, saving \$42MM over two years in direct costs, and improving customer experience.
- **Enhancing Personalization:** Built "NBx," a recommendation engine for off-lease, churn, and retention campaigns, leveraging LLMs to create email copy tailored to customer demographics and purchase predictions. Increased conversions by 7% (\$1.2MM Y/Y), generated \$10MM+ in sales, and improved customer retention

Data Scientist, FlexShopper – Atlanta, GA

May 2022 – February 2023

- **Increased Profitability:** Developed a multi-objective credit model which increased response rates by 31% while reducing application cost and default by 34% and 22% respectively.

Lead Graduate Associate Georgia Institute of Technology – Atlanta, GA

May 2020 – Present

Education

Georgia Institute of Technology – MS in Computational Data Analytics

May 2022

University of Georgia – BBA Finance - Specialization in Securities Valuation

May 2019

Skills

- **Languages:** Python, Lisp, Go, Terraform, R, JavaScript, C++ , MATLAB
- **Machine Learning:** Azure, AWS, Airflow, Kubernetes, Buildkite, Docker, DABs, MLOps, DevOps, SecOps, Sagemaker, Scripting, Distributed Storage & Computation,
- **Data Science:** Recommendation Systems, Foundational Embeddings, Imbalanced Learning, Deep Learning, Classification, Time-Series forecasting, Survival analysis, Anomaly Detection
- **Data Engineering:** PySpark, SQL, Mongo, Kafka, DLT, OpenRefine
- **Packages:** MlFlow, Tensorflow, Pytorch, Sklearn, Numpy, Pandas, Catboost, LangChain, Hugging Face, Ray, XGB

Projects

- **Alps:** Web App & Machine learning system developed for U.S. Olympic Committee for Alpine Skiing Team
- **Decision Tree Viz:** Python library developed to convert decision tree models into interactive html
- **EvanJones.AI:** personal website developed from scratch

Awards & Patents

- **Ragged Ranking for Hierarchical Prediction:** Paper on novel application of ragged tensors for LTR tasks
- **Mercedes-Benz Shining Star:** most impactful individual contributor Q2 2025
- **ECE:** intelligent system for automobile failure and repair prediction (patent pending)